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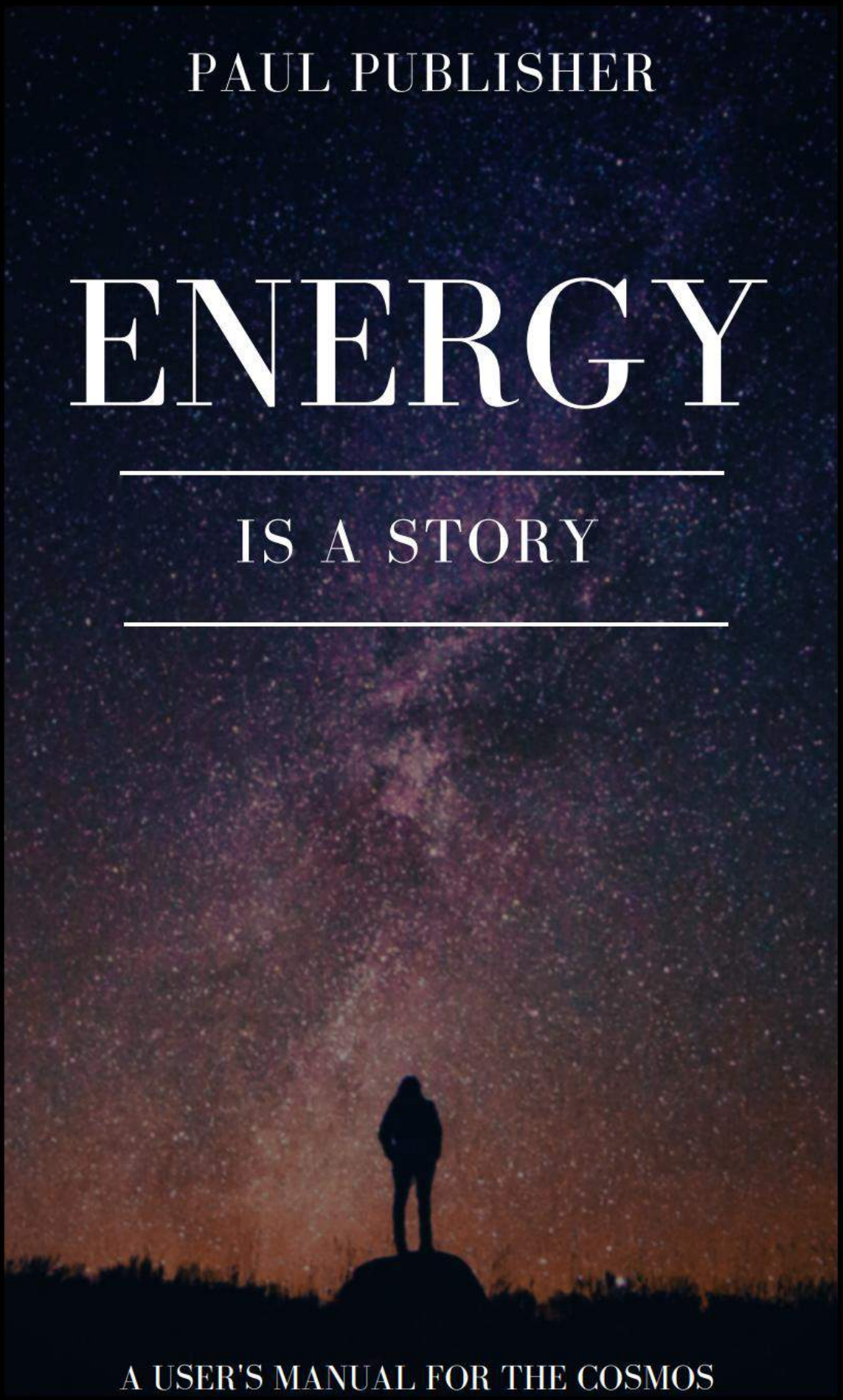
ENERGY

IS A STORY



A USER'S MANUAL FOR THE COSMOS

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Part One: Time and Space

Somewhere along the way, in the evolution of the online conversation, "energy" captivated our attention.

But what do we mean by "energy"? How can we be sure that we're talking about the same thing?

It is my mission to bring clarity to this conversation with a single motto:

Energy is a story.

And the best way to understand this motto is by understanding the mechanics of astrology. Because that's what astrology is: a story about energetic currents mixing together.

Again, we come to the problem of common understanding. One of the biggest stumbling blocks to astrology simply seems to be this question: How does it work?

Or, more plainly: How does it affect me? What can I do with it?

In my opinion, upon answering these questions, it's possible for someone to see all the other pieces of astrology fall quickly into place. Likewise, they will understand what is meant by the concept of "energy."

Which is great, because astrology can seem intimidating at first, full of numbers and planets that represent archetypal features of human consciousness.

After understanding how the clock of astrology ticks, you will realize that its numerous details form an elegant, harmonious system that can often be reasoned out with common sense.

For example, balance and complimentary opposites are principles under which an astrological analysis often operates.

So, let's start from the beginning. Let's provisionally define energy.

Energy is consciousness. And consciousness experiences certain limitations. The experience of consciousness is framed by Space and Time. You might be an American Civil War solider fighting at Gettysburg; you might be a Rastafarian in 1960s Jamaica.

Whatever the case may be, the experience of consciousness in both examples is neatly framed by a particular experience of Space and Time.

We can say consciousness is like a page in a book. Every page in the Book of Life has a particular energy. We know this on a gut level. No two historical periods, no two individuals, are the same.

Let's break this down to prove the point.

For consciousness to exist, the element of Time must be present. In every moment, a unit of time is transpiring. This occurs in a mathematical realm. It is measurable via numbers.

Space is the material crystallization of this mathematical abstraction. Space will change, degrade and/or transmute as the moment transpires. It is measurable via bodies.

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Numbers (time) and bodies (space). OK, we're getting somewhere. What do numbers and bodies have in common with each other?

Well, they both rely on relationships. 1 can be in relation to 2. If the relation is addition, we have the sum of 3.

Likewise, my body can be in relation to the cup of tea 1 foot away from me. Both of these objects are also in relation to the downtown area of my city, a distance of several miles.

Both the realm of time and the realm of space retain cohesion because everything in those realms depends on relationships.

Thus, we can say there is a unity of time and a unity of space. Both realms enjoy the experience of interconnectedness.

It sounds a bit hippy, but it's true: If my body and my cup of tea are spatially in relation to my city downtown, these bodies are also spatially related to some corner of Paris and Jakarta and Ontario…and even further out, to some patch of territory on the Moon, or even Mars. Etcetera.

Everything in space is unified and interconnected via relationality.

The same is true for time.

All moments of time share a relation to each other, because they are all measurable via numbers. And so, as with the above example about space, there is a unity of time.

One minute ago is the past; but so is one century ago. One month from now is the future; but so is a millennium. Etcetera.

Now, how might we visually represent these two abstractions: that all of space and all of time are infinitely unified in their own right, but also correspond like pen pals across the Atlantic Ocean?

We know they must correspond, because they are the two limitations always present during the experience of energy, which we're calling consciousness.

After all, if I were to drive to this downtown area we've been discussing, sure, I would traverse the relation that spatially separated us. But it would also take me time to do so. Maybe a few minutes if I drove. Much slower if I walked. Even slower if I crawled. And practically immediate if I flew.

Time and space are bound to each other like marriage partners, though they retain their own autonomy.

And here's an additional problem: unlike the Moon, let's say, I'm not a hunk of rock. I'm in a human body, and that's going to eventually give out on me. I will "die" in that instance. Worse, I'm acutely aware of this fact. The human condition is being aware of time but also aware of your own physical mortality.

Human consciousness is precisely where the realm of time and the realm of space retain fidelity in their marriage. You cannot be a human and live only in the realm of time or space. You must live within the union of both.

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That is energy. That is your subjective experience of consciousness.

Now the question is: how is your consciousness subjective? Why is it any different than, say, a person born a day after you? Or a century before you?

Ah, good question. Just because the infinite realm of time and space get married in an individual, doesn't mean he experiences all timelines and all configurations of space.

Instead, he experiences a single page, a single snapshot from the infinite realms of time and space.

Again, it's like a child born of marriage: your consciousness is just a very specific, very particular configuration plucked from these great pools of potential.

Because let's go back to the above example. I could've walked downtown. Or I could've driven. But I couldn't have done both—at least not simultaneously, that's for sure.

A choice had to be made. And in similar ways, souls make choices when they incarnate into a human consciousness. Some are extroverted action-seeking drivers, some are introverted leisurely walkers, just to use a simple example.

But let's stick with this idea of choice, because it's very important. Once your soul makes a choice to have a particular type of consciousness—we'll get to that selection process here in a bit—then as an individual you now live in the 3D material realm.

You've got to survive, make choices. And, as you might expect, these choices must grapple with the limitations of time and the limitations of space.

Man is acutely aware of the passage of time. He must make decisions, weigh intent and consequence, assess cost and risk. He does not have all the time in the world.

But he does not sit like a brain in a jar, playing this game in a purely immaterial realm of ideas and numbers. He has incarnated into an individual body, and his decisions build relationships in the spatial world, whether with other people or objects or natural elements.

Well, that's a lot of responsibility. You're born and you have a finite amount of time before you die. And to make matters more intense, you must exercise this time in a spatial realm, where loved ones get sick and drought kills crops but also where mothers give birth and where spring rain brings forth tender greens.

So what do you even do? How do you live? Are you so paralyzed by doubt that you just curl up in a ball? Or are you so overcome with frenzied compulsive activity that you just swing your caveman club at anything that comes your way?

Who knows, maybe your ancestors tried those options. But they weren't sustainable.

Man had to look beyond, to the cosmos, for guidance. He looked to the heavens—the place he came from, or at least the place he will ascend to upon that moment of death always hovering in the back of his mind.

And what did man see when he looked up at the sky? Well, if it was daytime, he saw the Sun. That's a good starting point. The Sun gives warmth and light.

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Then he looked up at night. Ooh. Things got really interesting then. Not only did he see a waxing and waning moon, but he also saw stars—in particular, star groups or star clusters, a.k.a. constellations.

Yes, constellations all around him, like a 360-degree movie screen. He wondered: was there a message in these shiny star dots? Were they code? Could the dots be connected to form symbols—animals, maybe—some kind of totemic image that would tell him the meaning of the moment he was living in?

After all, a 360-degree circle was how he seemed to experience life: all around him phenomena swirled, from relatives to wild animals to trees and rivers.

And this spatial scene changed over time. Yes, time too was like a circle, with a beginning and an end (which itself became the start of a new beginning).

Indeed, man realized that his basic experience of consciousness was half time and half space.

There were seasons of his life that he felt in his heart—a thing of time—and these were not unlike the changing natural seasons he understood at a fleshy spatial level.

Ah, maybe that's it, he wondered. As the constellations changed, so did the natural seasons—and so did the material events transpiring around him.

Even more than that, the events transpiring *within* him—his thoughts, emotions, judgements, his whole subjective outlook—these too changed in accordance with the scroll of stars.

The stars were like time or like his awareness of thoughts, emotions, sensations. A temporal thing.

The natural seasons and physical weather were like space.

But he had to live in both realms. His consciousness demanded it. He could be neither just a giant clock nor just a lump of flesh. He had to be made up of both—and he saw both outside of himself, in the sky and on the earth.

As the child of both, he felt a duty to understand Father Time and Mother Earth. After all, so many choices, so many potential outcomes existed for him and his tribe. He needed to honor both Father and Mother—and the best way to honor them was to understand how they communicated. Surely they were communicating something of importance to his bottom line. He was their child!

And so man studied and mapped the star movements and compared them to phenomena happening within him and outside him. He found congruence between the Father and the Mother—or shall we say, a correspondence between these starry markers of time and the spatial events happening around him.

He realized he was the bridge between time and space. His experience—this subjective pulse of life flowing through him up until the moment of death—was consciousness.

And that consciousness was merely the child recognizing that the starry markers of time and the spatial events happening around were in holy matrimony!

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His consciousness was energy. His consciousness was the energetic childlike product of Father Time and Mother Earth.

He sat around a campfire with his fellow men and sought ways to describe this matrimonial conversation. He described this conversation through *story*.

With story there could be totemic characters or archetypes like Cancer the Crab or Leo the Lion. Maybe some seasons these animals were at war with each other; at other times there were truces or gestures of love.

These stories were used to make sense of the events that had been happening around the tribe—and which were happening that very moment.

Likewise, thanks to accumulated observation, man could even suggest or perhaps predict what might transpire in the future.

This is the basis of astrology as story—of energy as a story.

And it all occurred in a circle around a campfire, just like the planets and stars around the fiery Sun.

Hmm. A circle. What a beautiful symbol of unity and infinity.

Couldn't drawing a circle be the perfect way to consolidate the correspondence between space and time—and man's role as storyteller in bridging the two?

Thus, the Zodiac was born. The Wheel of Life. An ideal arena, just like a campfire, for telling the story of what has been, what is and what will be.

Past, present, future: all is contained within the circle.

Circle of Life. One is born, one dies. You return from whence you came. Your body returns to dust, ashes to ashes. Your mind returns to the realm of time.

Faced with this mortality and the myriad choices he could make, man did what seemed reasonable: he'd turn his life, and the life of his tribe, into the most epic story it could be.

He would live out his birthright: he would reconcile time and space in his very being, in his consciousness, in his energy.

Every act, every breath would be living proof of the correspondence between the clock of Time and the plane of Space.

Man danced around the campfire, with the rhythm of word and story at his disposal.

He would seek to live in poetic harmony with the seasons on Earth and the seasons in the sky. He would be the harmonic link. He would be a child of God—of Father Time and Mother Earth.

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Part Two: Fate and Free Will

The material planets—which are balls of gas moving in outer space—exist in mathematical relation to each other, and these relations change over time, as they move. We are able to map these relations by plotting their movements on a circle.

But what exactly is this circle and how are we able to accurately map these relations?

After all, if the planetary relations are the meat of the celestial story that has attracted man's attention, we'd better hope that our graphic simulation of their chatter is in some way accurate.

Good news: There is congruence between the physical planetary movements and the mathematical map we create called a Zodiac.

A primary reason for this is because, due to physical laws, planetary bodies interact with each other on a flat plane. Taking the Sun as the center of our universe, they all rotate around this Sun at different speeds, but on the same plane, making mathematical relations to each other along the way.

Again, we can mimic this graphically by drawing a circle on paper and tracking the planets as they move along different points of this circle.

But that still doesn't answer a fundamental part of this question: what are the units we are using to track the planetary movements? And why should we trust this unit of measurement?

Now we come to the next step. One must imagine, that in the middle of this Zodiac—which is a circular movie screen composed of 12 star groups a.k.a. Zodiac signs—is the Sun.

And around this Sun is a circle, called the ecliptic: this is the path the Earth makes as it revolves around the Sun.

As the Earth revolves around the Sun on this ecliptic, the Sun and other planets appear to "travel" against the backdrop of the constellated movie screen.

Of all the planets, the Sun is the most constant mover, *from our perspective on Earth.*

Remember, astrology is a human-based system, so it takes on the biases of souls living on Earth. Thus, we have to indulge these abstractions—such as drawing circles on paper—while we work out the problem of what our souls are doing here. That's just the way it is.

Our Sun is the source of Life and Light, but it's also our source of Time.

At the most basic level, our calendar is a Solar Calendar.

And the calendar is really how we get in touch with the temporal, or time-based, side of our consciousness. Our 5 senses are how we get in touch with the spatial side of our consciousness.

As man was watching this changing procession of Zodiac signs in the night sky, he eventually noticed that the Sun moves roughly 1 degree a day within a 360-degree Zodiac. The same number of degrees in a circle. The annual Wheel of Life. About 90 degrees per season—spring, summer, fall and winter.

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This is where we get the 365-day calendar year from (because the Sun on some days doesn't move a full degree).

In other words, the Sun is the steadiest stream of energy moving across the 12 Zodiac signs, year in and year out. How beautiful it does so one degree, one day at a time—for what is a life but a brief day?

And truly, man realized that the 12 signs tell a progressive, linear story which opens with the birth of a child and progresses up through puberty and marriage and building his tribal legacy and so on, up until death.

It's so important that the Sun is the celestial body that outlines this story without fail every year. Indeed, as our preeminent source of Light and Life, the Sun is a symbol of a unique spark, like the life of an individual.

Each human is unique so it's easy for us to see ourselves in the Sun, as if we are all seemingly the only person to have experienced birth and death, or the comedies and tragedies befalling a tribe—though of course we know this isn't the case.

Anyways, because the Sun outlines this annual universal human story of birth to death—laboring to shine on each individual calendar day a special birthday vibe, as if it's always a particular page of energy—that means this solar calendar in total is like a foundational BOOK OF LIFE.

Yes, due to its dependability and universal applicability to the human condition, this solar calendar creates a structured book of blank pages upon which the infinite variations of planetary movements can be written. How ironic: a story full of blank pages. The structure for your humanity is there, but you are free to tell any epic tale of yourself within those limitations.

So while each individual calendar day retains its own unique solar identity in the progressive story, no matter the year, this basic warm energy many times gets rather buried to our perceptions, much like our subliminal awareness of the warm white paper upon which a novel is written. The attention of our consciousness is trained on the unique planetary dance happening—the scene on the paper.

As we've been saying, these movements are the ever-changing scenes of our world—the seasons of our lives. They are in correspondence with the material phenomena swirling around us, and the psycho-emotional phenomena swirling within us. We know these scenes are ultimately contextualized on the blank page of the solar calendar—i.e. the BOOK OF LIFE—and so we have some kind of foundation for these myriad scenes to appear on.

So, again, just to summarize: During the Sun's annual journey, the universal human story unfolds one day at a time. Remember what the Sun does: It shines light so you can see. It gives you some kind of basic structure so your consciousness can walk around.

Each day is a solar page in this circular story about Man forging sovereign authenticity out of chaos. He will merge with this chaos again upon death. And it may be a metaphorical death: think of the death of winter followed by rebirth at the Spring Equinox.

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When the Sun reaches the end of one Zodiac sign, there are enough pages to form a chapter. And every three chapters—or every three months—there's a new season.

Putting all these pages or chapters together, every year the Sun gives us the blank Book of Life upon which we can write the story of our sovereign authenticity. It is a fatherly gift to us: this foundation provides the authority of temporal law, protecting the expression of our energy, our consciousness.

The motherly gift is the richness of the material world, of our 5 senses, which nurtures and grounds our energy, our consciousness in an individual physical body.

But again, at a macro level, the perimeters are always the same, the seasons always fall at the same pace and have the same flavor, but the scenes are tweaked by the unique planetary movements. Some planets move fast, so one theme in a scene may transpire in a day or the course of a few weeks. Some planets move slow, and so it's a theme that extends across seasons, providing background richness and continuity as quicker props get switched out.

We know this on a gut level, even, just by looking at our own lives. No two years are the same, and yet the days of late October are always filled with spooky energy, for example – they are the always the pages of the Sun "moving through" the constellation of Scorpio.

So, to summarize thus far: while this solar agri-cultural story is told yearly with days that grow long and that eventually shorten, the planetary dance is unique – the scenes that take place on the blank page are unique.

And these scenes show up not only in the plottable points of heavenly bodies, but are reflected in the inscrutable wisdom of the living material planet Earth–and furthermore, within the inscrutable realm of man's heart, emotions, perceptions, thought.

I suppose if we could crack the code of how the physical Mother Earth itself is an autonomous living thing—often called "Gaia"—or if we could crack the code of man's heart, which hides the cruelest murders and the most saintly forgiveness, then we would have no need for watching the heavens, celestial bodies or other markers of time.

But we can't crack those codes. They all exist in relation to each other, while retaining their independence, just like a mother and father in marriage–and just as a child is an embodiment of that matrimonial bond.

Thus, man is always scrutinizing these scenes—in the heavens, on the earth, in his heart—because he's on a mission to forge his sovereign authenticity, to bridge space and time, to live life to its fullest.

Ah, and guess what? Not only does man find congruence or correspondence between these scenes. More importantly, scenes require characters. That's where man finally gets some sense of how to act and gauge risk as he's living life to his fullest. It is up to us to speak, to flesh out these scenes with dialog, choice, drama, action.

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If there's a Book of Life that gets renewed every year, and retains the same parameters, but which experiences energetic changes in scenery deeper than the physical spring-to-winter change, then man must acknowledge that.

There's no reason to deliver lines like a cowboy if the scene is taking place in Victorian England. Man aspires to harmony with the cosmos, remember, just as he aspires to harmony with seasonal physical weather, or furthermore, with social and psycho-emotional weather around and within him.

He wants to know how to deliver the best lines appropriate to the scene.

He knows it's the same weather, just different faces—space and time—and he's challenged to live under the authority of both. But he knows he's the fusion of both authorities, and so in studying the correspondence between both, he's really studying the pages and scenes of his own heart.

But is man a mere slave to the scene? Has he no inspiration or inclination beyond what is given to him? Does he cower in fear of celestial movements in the fatherly heavens? Does he quiver with confusion at the drought of late summer? Does he dumbly blink at the anger or sadness or joy or brilliant solutions rising up inside him—these pulses which are nothing more than an amalgamation of the sky above him and the ground upon which his feet rest?

Man is more than a slave. He is an ambitious creature. He loves risk. He seeks to honor these pulses of energy in his consciousness. He cries, he laughs, he creates, he fails. Like any good child, he honors his parents, Father Time and Mother Earth—but he grows to forge his own sovereignty, and exercises free will, with feeling and force and choice.

Man is also different from his neighbor as he expresses himself in the ever-changing scene. He makes different choices, feels different emotions, ends up at a different fate. It seems that man already has a life script, a rather mutable soul script—despite coming from the same parents as his neighbor, he has a unique consciousness that his soul has selected, as we hinted at a few paragraphs above.

The lines in this soul script will work for any given scene, all throughout life. But he must express these in a certain way, he must act on them in a certain way, so that they harmonize with the scene.

Again, we know this on a gut level. People will focus on their strengths when they figure out a way to exercise them accurately in the moment, after they assess what's going on. And they will exercise these native strengths with great feeling. We commonly refer to this as decision or choice or free will.

You see, your birth chart is merely a snapshot that froze a scene as it was dynamically forming on the Book of Life.

In a way, then, you are one of those very unique scenes isolated and embodied in physical form. You also embody that particular window or scene in your "heart," which we'll loosely call a collection of thoughts, emotions, perceptions—anything time-based and not material, in other words.

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It's really crazy that you just don't embody this marriage of time and space in just a corporeal form: you're not just a tank that roves around, eating, fucking and conquering your way through the Earth.

You also have a spiritual consciousness that is aware of Time, you are also connected temporally to this snapshot—so the birth chart also governs how you perceive, emote, learn, desire, etc.

It's like a page torn out of the giant solar Book of Life, which has a particular scene written on it. This is your **soul script**. Your soul remembers very well this particular scene as it landed on the blank Book of Life on that year, that date, that hour and minute, at that specific location.

So yes, your script gives you a certain attraction to certain scenes of life. It makes you appear in certain ways to others. But since it's *your* scene and no one else's I won't refer to it as a scene really: it is a **script**, and you use that script to manage how you will act in the **ever-changing macro scene** that transpires over the course of your life.

Let's pause once more to summarize: we've been saying the scene perpetually changes moment to moment, though it's written on a foundational blank page, on a solar Book of Life that renews every year to accept the unique scenes.

And we've been saying your consciousness, or your energy, is like one of those scenic pages snatched from the book—so that it becomes your unalterable script, a thing you carry with you throughout life, which contains all information you'd ever need, including your destiny and karma.

Yet while this script remains unaltered, and gives you certain strengths and weakness as you try to express yourself in the ever-changing scene…there's something we must again emphasize strongly.

We have to ask: why is it difficult to act within this ever-changing scene of life? Why is risk always present? Why do we have to deal with particular strengths and weaknesses? Isn't that unjust? Shouldn't we all have the same strengths and weaknesses? And shouldn't the scene be more accommodating to us?

Ah, the questions of life. What you see as risk and the injustices of a cruel world are also openings for you to be free, to jump in and improvise your lines, to live the fullness of your consciousness!

True, moment to moment, your script is always *contextualized* by the ever-changing macro scene in which the lines must be voiced and expressed. So while it might be strange to speak like a cowboy in Victorian England, you're free to do so—and you'll reap all the consequences, or perhaps bizarre happy accidents, that result from that free will decision.

Astrology is ultimately an ethical paradigm because it challenges you to act in harmony with the prevailing scene, even though you don't have to. And it challenges you to push the limits of harmony. You don't have to live in silent slavish obeyance to the context: you can really probe it, test out the borders of harmony, see the limits of a situation, speak like a cowboy in front of high society debutantes and see your energy taking shape in the moment. That's life.

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Because, after all, while a child submits to the authority of his father and mother, he grows to become a man, graduates past their expectations, and comes to see parts of their authority within himself—he is truly their child in the fullest sense. It is his destiny, his life, his death—and his alone.

But love is always present in this individual challenge of destiny. As man wanders under the watch of Father Time and upon Mother Earth, and grows to test their limits, he is never separate from them within his consciousness—and so even the poorest of choices is little more than a line that contrasted with a passing scene, not eternal damnation to permanent failure.

Again, man's mission is to live his energy to its fullest, good bad and ugly—and he does that through acknowledging his own strengths and weaknesses but also by gauging the scene he's acting in, by reflecting on the ongoing conversation between the sky and the earth.

Man ultimately wants to be larger than life. He wants his energy to be a story. He wants to live seasons of life to the fullest.

Again, this is why risk is always present—your improvised lines could fall flat; you could forget them or neglect them; or you could simply be catching someone at a time when *their* script is being adversely affected by the macro scene, which you're *both* acting in.

That's the funny thing: you could interpret the prevailing energy as favorable to your bottom line, but neglect to remember that everyone else has a different script, which makes their ability to act in any given scene easier or harder, depending on the makeup of their unique consciousness or soul script.

It might be a good day for you, and a bad day for your boss, given the prevailing scene. Then you both interact, pushing forward with your various agendas. And so the complexity of human relationships just smacks you in the face, soon as you greet someone.

You grit your teeth and mutter that they could live in harmonic accordance with their soul script, and accept their bad day, and just see your point of view. And they grit their teeth, muttering that you should live in harmonic accordance with your script and so be a little more patient.

But, once more, this is also why you aren't compelled against your will to live out a predetermined fate, and neither are other people. You can probe the limits of any given scene you're speaking within. Misunderstandings can pop up—but they can also be repaired. Disagreements can turn into forgiveness.

Indeed, an individual's life—your life—is the most epic story of all, as we've been saying. Because while you strive to live in harmony with the ever-changing scene and even the solar Book of Life these scenes are written upon, it's your choices that constitute the true activity of the scene.

The planets aren't just out there, sending you bad luck. No. They are just the temporal, the time-based part of your consciousness. The rain doesn't fall on your head because Mother Earth hates you. No. It's just the material, the spatial-based part of your consciousness.

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In your heart, you try to reconcile the passage of time with the material events happening around you…and what happens is that you arrive at the **meaning** of a particular window, a particular scene.

You make a choice. Or you reflect on a choice made. Or you speculate on choices you could make.

And ultimately, while you assess the ostensible meaning of these seasons of your life, past present future, the true focal point is your consciousness: it all comes down to how you act, what you say, the choices you make.

You manifest energy. You make the conversation between sky and earth a reality. And so do the other people around you, creating much drama.

The decisions you make, the emotions you feel, the breaths you take—these are the final lines in the Book of Life. All else is a scene, waiting for you to live.

Life is a mix of free will and predetermined cycles. Life is what you make of your inheritance from Father Time and Mother Earth.

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If you'd like specifics on how to deliver your best lines amid the changing seasons of life—and how to dance around the dramas of others doing their best to live—contact me: paul@paulpublisher.com.

I offer birth chart readings that reveal the totality of your soul script.

For an example of what a reading can reveal, read my follow-up to this treatise: The Astro Cheat Sheet.

This is also a great one-hour bootcamp for anyone wanting to understand the basics of astrology. Thank you!

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